

ETHAN WOELBERN

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EDUCATION

University of California Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara

BA, Religious Studies (Theta Alpha Kappa); Concentration: Secularization Ethics, and the Philosophy of Religion, College of Letters and Sciences (Dean's Honors), June 2027

Thesis: "Viewing the World: Aspect Perception and Kantian themes in Wittgenstein and Heidegger"

Advisor: Dr. Thomas Carlson

BA, Writing and Literature; College of Creative Studies (Honors), June 2027

Research Thesis: "Confessing our Finitude: Authority, Judgement, and Speech in Hegelian Forgiveness"

Creative Thesis: "Fragments on Landscaping: Philosophical Investigations on Southern California Garden Culture"

Advisor: Dr. James Donelan

AWARDS & HONORS

Raab Fellow

Writing Program; November 2025 - Present

- Selected for Writing Department Research Fellowship
- Advised by Dr. James Donelan
- Planned and produced a research paper on Hegel's appropriation of Luther's sacrament of penance

Arnhold Fellow

English Department; January 2025 – May 2025

- Selected for English Department Research Grant
- Advised by Professor Jeremy Douglass and Graduate Mentor Becca Hamilton
- Planned and produced a research paper comparing Walt Whitman to Stanley Cavell's notion of Emersonian Perfectionism

Edward C. Truman Award

Religious Studies Department; May 2026

- Presented annually to a freshman, sophomore, or junior student who is deemed outstanding by the Department of Religious Studies and the UCSB Affiliates.

SURF (Summer Undergraduate Research Fund) Grant

College of Creative Studies, Writing and Literature Department; Summer 2026

- Selected for CCS Summer Research Grant
- Advised by Dr. James Donelan
- Writing a nonfiction work concerning the connection between Philosophy and Landscaping

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Religious Studies 238 - Catholic Studies: Love and Language

Dr. William Robert, Winter 2026

- Term Paper: "Wittenstein's Confessions"
- Surveyed a series of Catholic Mystic Theologians from Saint Augustine to Mechthild of Magdeburg around their uses of language and love

Religious Studies 223 - Religion and Modernity Nature and Politics

Dr. Thomas Carlson, Winter 2025

- Term Paper: "Cavell's Whitman: Emersonian Perfectionism, the Ordinary, and the Openness of Democracy"
- Highlight specific skills, qualities, and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

Religious Studies 223 - Religion and Modernity: Phenomenology

Dr. Thomas Carlson, Spring 2024

- Term Paper: "Escaping Modernity: Enchantment, Heidegger, and Myth in Joyce's Ulysses"

- Highlight specific skills, qualities, and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

Comp Lit 200 – Competitive Seminar: Walter Benjamin

Dr. Elizabeth Weber, Fall 2025

- Term Paper: “Bild contra Bildung: The Question of Immediacy in Benjamin’s Dialectical Image”
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

Poli Sci 197 - Senior Seminar: Impartiality and Politics

Dr. Andrew Norris, Winter 2025

- Term Paper: “Of Each Other: The Necessity of Acknowledgement and Towards a Partial Politics”
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

Poli Sci 197 - Senior Seminar: Hegel’s Phenomenology of Spirit

Dr. Andrew Norris, Fall 2025

- Term Paper: “Authority in Sinfulness: Hegel’s Forgiveness at the End of ‘Spirit’ and its Lutheran Imports”
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

English 197 - Senior Seminar: Ulysses

Dr. Enda Duffy, Spring 2025

- Term Paper: “The Diremption of Love and Law in Joyce’s Ithaca”
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

PAPERS & PRESENTATIONS

Woelbern, E. (2026). *Confessing Our Finitude: Hegel’s Critique of Romanticism*, NASSR Undergraduate Research Event, Pasadena, CA. (Upcoming)

Woelbern, E. (2026). *Confessing our Finitude: Authority, Judgement, and Speech in Hegelian Forgiveness*, URCA Conference, Santa Barbara, CA. (Upcoming)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UCSB College of Creative Studies

Tentative: Writing and Literature Department, (September 2026 – December 2026)

- CS 5: Philosophy as Literature, Literature as Philosophy

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Most Recent Employer Name, City, STATE (or Country if non-US)

Title, Department, Starting-Ending Dates (Month/Year – Month/Year)

- Accomplishments and accountabilities in following formula:
- Action verb + Accomplishment/Accountability + Results (see example below)
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

Previous Employer Name, City, STATE (or Country if non-US)

Title, Department, Starting-Ending Dates (Month/Year – Month/Year)

- Accomplishments and accountabilities in following formula:
- Action verb + Accomplishment/Accountability + Results (see example below)
- Highlight specific skills, qualities and attributes demonstrated; Include quantifiable results

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- Research Interests: Philosophy of Religion, Metaethics, Existentialism, Ordinary Language Philosophy, History of Philosophy
- Skills: Writing, Copyediting, Prompt Generation, Legal Writing, First Aid/CPR Certified
- Technical Proficiencies: Microsoft Services (Word, PowerPoint, Excel), Adobe Services (Photoshop, Lightroom, InDesign), Electrical Wiring, Irrigation and Sprinkler Repair, and Heavy Machinery Experience
- Languages: French (A2), German (B1-B2)

REFERENCES

Thomas Carlson

Professor of Religious Studies, UC Santa Barbara

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Jim Donelan

Senior Continuing Lecturer in English, Writing Studies and the College of Creative Studies, UC Santa Barbara

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Andrew Norris

Professor of Political Science, UC Santa Barbara

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